Ford Motor Company

James P. Vondale, Director
Automotive Safety Office
Environmental & Safety Engineering

January 18, 2002

Mr. Kenneth N. Weinstein
Associate Administrator for Safety Assurance
National Highway Traffic Safety Administration
400 Seventh Street, S.W.
Washington, D.C. 20590

Dear Mr. Weinstein:

Re: Ford Recall No. 02S31 – 2000-2002 Model Year F-650 and F-750 Trucks Equipped with Trailer Package

Summary

- Ford Action – Ford is conducting a safety recall involving 2000-2002 Model Year F-650 and F-750 Trucks equipped with Trailer Package. This does not affect F-650 and F-750 tractor package vehicles, which were introduced in the 2002 model year.

- Number of Vehicles Involved – 555 vehicles (549 in the United States and federalized territories and 6 in Canada).

- Noncompliance - In affected vehicles, the air brake lines connected to the tractor protection valve are misrouted so that they do not comply with FMVSS 121 Section 5.7.3 since the primary and secondary air brake circuits are not isolated for the trailers brake system.

- Affect on Vehicle Operation – Trucks equipped with the trailer package have the air brake lines connected to the tractor protection valve routed so that, in the event of a leak in the primary air brake line, the secondary air brake line will not modulate the trailer brake system. This may result in a reduction or loss of trailer brakes effectiveness. Ford is not aware of any reports of reduction or loss of trailer brake effectiveness on Ford vehicles, or of any reports alleging that a fire, accident, injury, or fatality occurred.

- Service Procedure – Dealers will be instructed to reposition the primary and secondary brake lines attached to the tractor protection valve.

Sincerely,

James P. Vondale

Attachment
02S31 5d/kek

ATTACHMENT

49 CFR Part 573 -- DEFECT INFORMATION REPORT
02S31 – 2000-2002 MODEL YEAR F-650 / F-750 TRUCKS WITH TRAILER PACKAGE

Pursuant to Part 573 of Title 49 of the Code of Federal Regulations, Defect and Noncompliance Reports, Ford Motor Company submits the following information concerning a safety recall action that it is voluntarily initiating.

573.5 (c) (2) -- Potentially Affected Vehicles

2000-2002 Model Year F-650 and F-750 trucks equipped with trailer package built at the Cuautitlan Assembly Plant between May 16, 2000 and December 11, 2001.

This does not affect F-650 and F-750 tractor package vehicles, which were introduced in the 2002 Model Year.

Because these vehicles are not produced in VIN order, information as to the applicability of this action to specific vehicles can best be obtained by either calling Ford's toll-free line (1-800-392-3673) or contacting a local Ford dealer, who can obtain specific information regarding the vehicles from the Ford On-line Automotive Service Information System (OASIS) database.

573.5 (c) (3) -- Estimated Population of Vehicles Potentially Affected

549 F-650 and F-750 trucks equipped with trailer package.

573.5 (c) (4) -- Estimated Percentage of Affected Vehicles with the Defect Condition

100 %

573.5 (c) (5) --Description of the Noncompliance

FMVSS 121 S5.7.3 requires the air brake to modulate under secondary control. On 2000-2002 Model Year F-650 and F-750 trucks equipped with the trailer package the air brake lines connected to the tractor protection valve are routed so that, in the event of a leak in the primary air brake line, the secondary air brake line will not modulate the trailer brake system. This may result in a reduction or loss of trailer brakes effectiveness. Ford is not aware of any reports of reduction or loss of trailer brake effectiveness on Ford vehicles, or of any reports alleging that a fire, accident, injury, or fatality occurred.

ATTACHMENT

573.5 (c) (7) – Basis of Determination of Noncompliance

During a review of 2002 Model Year vehicles Ford Engineering discovered a discrepancy with the air line plumbing to the Tractor Protection Valve. The air brake lines connected to the tractor protection valve were routed so that, in the event of a leak in the primary air brake line, the secondary air brake line would not modulate the trailer brake system. FMVSS 121 S5.7.3 requires the air brake to modulate under secondary control.

Further review determined that 2000-2002 Model Year F-650 and F-750 trucks equipped with the trailer package produced from May 16, 2000 to December 11, 2001 are affected.

573.5 (c) (8) -- Service Program

Ford has notified dealers not to drive, demonstrate, or deliver the affected vehicles until the primary and secondary brake lines have been repositioned. Ford will begin notifying owners of record of affected vehicles in or about the week of February 18, 2002 to return their vehicles to dealers for the repositioning of the primary and secondary brake lines attached to the tractor protection valve.

There will be no charge to owners for this service.

573.5 (c) (9) -- Press statement and Dealer/Owner Letters

Ford does not plan to make a public statement concerning the subject matter of this action. A copy of the Notification letters to dealers and owners from Ford will be forwarded when available.

573.5 (c) (11) -- Recall Number

Ford has assigned recall number 02S31 to this action.